ELIXIR Cancer Data Community

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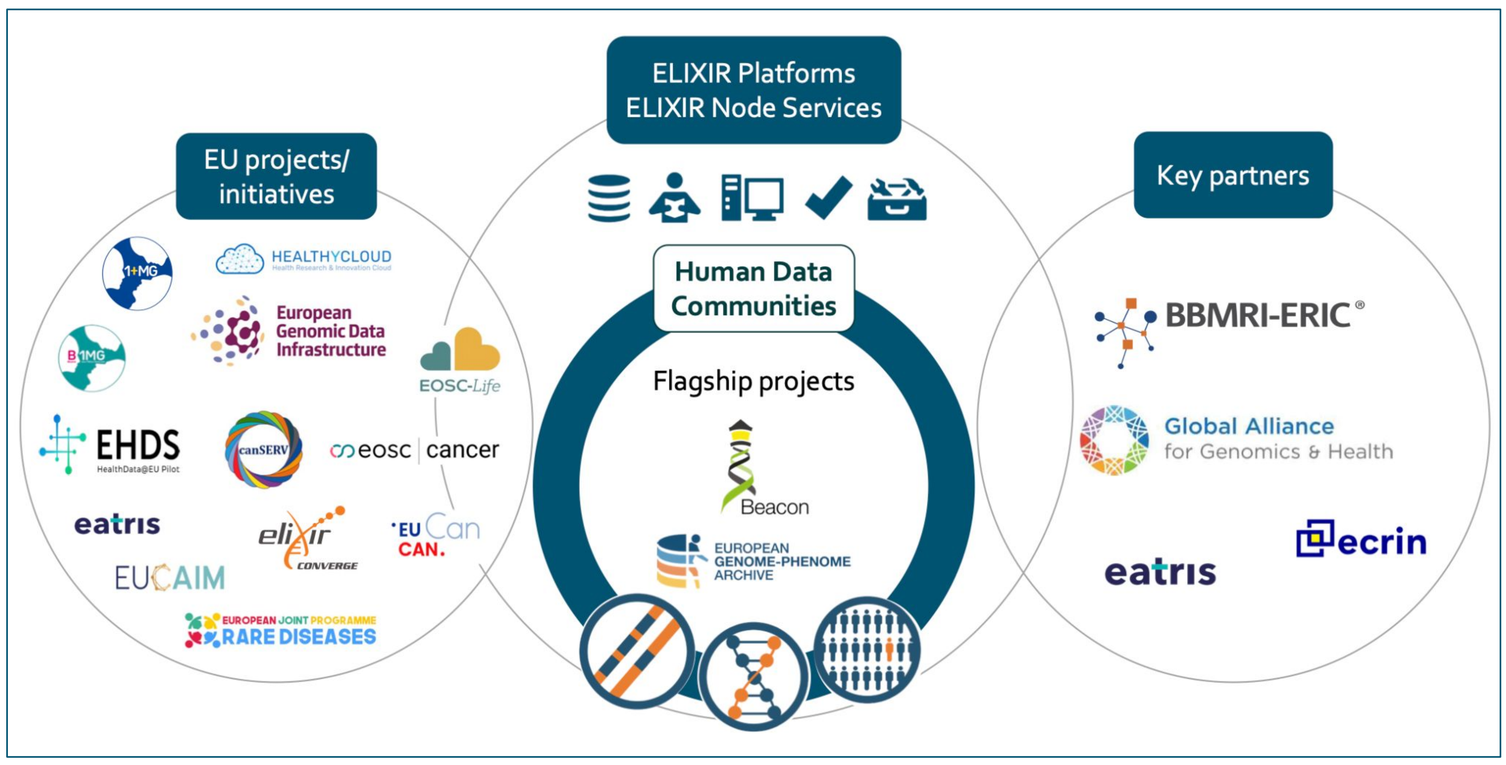
Background

Gold-standard cancer data management is pivotal to enable precision medicine for European citizens. Achieving this goal relies on key elements: adopting standardized data formats, ensuring robust data privacy, educating professionals about the infrastructure's benefits and leveraging cutting-edge technologies to transform cancer care. Broad interoperability of data, metadata, research software and computational infrastructure is critical for capitalizing on the potential of extensive datasets.



The roadmap paper outlines:

Steps	Aims
Disseminate existing open solutions	• Promote the adoption of global standards to ensure resource interoperability and support common interest • Promote the adoption and distribution of trusted standard and portable pipelines for cancer data analyses and interpretation
Promote cross-project and cross-initiative collaborations	• Create strong connections with other ELIXIR Communities and with the core ELIXIR resources (FAIR data, database interoperability, etc) • Build upon the ongoing efforts for cancer use-cases in different European projects both for research and towards cancer precision medicine
Design and develop missing community standards	• Contribute to discoverability and facilitated sharing of cancer data • Support the development of AI-based solutions trained on large non-biased high quality datasets

References

1. Nikolski, M., Hovig, E., Al-Shahrour, F., Blomberg, N., Scollen, S., Valencia, A., & Saunders, G. (2024). Roadmap for a European cancer data management and precision medicine infrastructure. Nature Cancer, 1-6.

The ELIXIR Cancer Data Community has recently been established

The ELIXIR Cancer Data Community was established following the publication of the White paper[1]. Through collaborative actions, ELIXIR aims to harness key partners' and other EU initiatives' collective expertise and resources, fostering a holistic approach to gathering, managing and analyzing clinical and biomedical data. By joining forces with other initiatives focused on human data, ELIXIR strives to enhance data infrastructure, accessibility, quality and interoperability, ultimately accelerating breakthroughs in biomedical research and promoting data-informed decision-making.

We will drive cancer perspectives within ELIXIR

Cancer research is among the data-richest areas, and where data sharing will be crucial towards realising the potential of precision cancer medicine. Pilot projects, funding opportunities and proposals, lectures on relevant topics, policy development, and more, are all parts of our scope.

Do you have an interest in cancer?

- **Join our meetings (4th Thursday of the month at 16:00 CET)**
- **Help in shaping the future direction of ELIXIR in tackling cancer, through project activities and policy development**

Contact

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